

Cunda the Smith

Cunda Sutta (Ud 8.5)

Evam me sutam— ekam samayam bhagavā mallesu cārikam caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ yena pāvā tadavasari. Tatra sudam bhagavā pāvāyam viharati cundassa kammāraputtassa ambavane.

Thus have I heard— At one time the Blessed One, while wandering on a tour among the Mallas with a large community of monks (*bhikkhusaṅgha*), arrived at Pāvā. There, the Blessed One stayed in Pāvā at the mango grove of Cunda the smith.

Assosi kho cundo kammāraputto: “bhagavā kira mallesu cārikam caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ pāvaṃ anupatto pāvāyam viharati mayham ambavane”ti. Atha kho cundo kammāraputto yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami; upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. Ekamantaṃ nisinnam kho cundam kammāraputtam bhagavā dhammiyā kathāya sandassesī samādapesī samuttejesī sampahaṃsesī. Atha kho cundo kammāraputto bhagavatā dhammiyā kathāya sandassito samādapito samuttejito sampahaṃsito bhagavantam etadavoca: “adhivāsetu me, bhante, bhagavā svātanāya bhattam saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā”ti. Adhivāsesī bhagavā tuṇhībhaveṇa.

Cunda the smith heard: "The Blessed One, it is said, while wandering on a tour among the Mallas with a large community of monks, has arrived at Pāvā and is staying in Pāvā at my mango grove." Then, Cunda the smith went to the Blessed One; having approached, he paid respects to the Blessed One and sat down to one side. As Cunda the smith sat there, the Blessed One instructed, encouraged, inspired, and gladdened him with a talk on the Dhamma (*dhamma*). Then, Cunda the smith, having been instructed, encouraged, inspired, and gladdened by the Blessed One's talk on the Dhamma, said to the Blessed One: "Bhante, may the Blessed One accept tomorrow's meal from me, together with the community of monks." The Blessed One accepted by remaining silent.

Atha kho cundo kammāraputto bhagavato adhivāsanaṃ viditvā uṭṭhāyāsan bhagavantam abhivādetvā padakkhiṇam katvā pakkāmi. Atha kho cundo kammāraputto tassā rattiyaṃ accayena sake nivesane paṇītaṃ khādanīyaṃ bhojanīyaṃ paṭiyādāpetvā pahūtaṃca sūkaramaddavaṃ bhagavato kālaṃ ārocāpesī: “kālo, bhante, niṭṭhitaṃ bhattam”ti.

Then, Cunda the smith, understanding that the Blessed One had accepted, rose from his seat, paid respects to the Blessed One, and keeping him on his right, departed. When the night had passed, Cunda the smith had choice food and delicacies prepared in his home, along with a

large quantity of a traditional delicacy (*sūkaramaddava*), and had the time announced to the Blessed One: "It is time, Bhante, the meal is ready."

Atha kho bhagavā pubbaṇhasamayam nivāsetvā pattacīvaramādāya saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghena yena cundassa kammāraputtassa nivesanam tenupasaṅkami; upasaṅkamtivā paññatte āsane nisīdi. Nisajja kho bhagavā cundam kammāraputtam āmantesi: "yam te, cunda, sūkaramaddavam paṭiyattam tena maṃ parivisa, yam panaññam khādanīyam bhojanīyam paṭiyattam tena bhikkhusaṅgham parivisā"ti. "Evaṃ, bhante"ti kho cundo kammāraputto bhagavato paṭissutvā yam ahosi sūkaramaddavam paṭiyattam tena bhagavantam parivisi; yam panaññam khādanīyam bhojanīyam paṭiyattam tena bhikkhusaṅgham parivisi.

Then the Blessed One, dressing in the morning, took his bowl and outer robe and, together with the community of monks, went to Cunda the smith's home. Having arrived, he sat on the prepared seat. Having sat down, the Blessed One addressed Cunda the smith: "Cunda, serve me with the *sūkaramaddava* you have prepared, and serve the community of monks with the other foods and delicacies." "Yes, Bhante," Cunda the smith replied to the Blessed One. He served the Blessed One with the prepared *sūkaramaddava*, and served the community of monks with the other foods and delicacies.

Atha kho bhagavā cundam kammāraputtam āmantesi: "yam te, cunda, sūkaramaddavam avasiṭṭham taṃ sobbhe nikhaṇāhi. Nāham taṃ, cunda, passāmi sadevake loke samārake sabrahmake sassamaṇabrāhmaṇiyā pajāya sadevamanussāya yassa taṃ paribhuttaṃ sammā pariṇāmaṃ gaccheyya aññatra tathāgatassā"ti. "Evaṃ, bhante"ti kho cundo kammāraputto bhagavato paṭissutvā yam ahosi sūkaramaddavam avasiṭṭham taṃ sobbhe nikhaṇitvā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami; upasaṅkamtivā bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. Ekamantaṃ nisinnaṃ kho cundam kammāraputtam bhagavā dhammiyā kathāya sandassetvā samādapetvā samuttejetvā sampahamsetvā utṭhāyāsanā pakkāmi.

Then the Blessed One addressed Cunda the smith: "Cunda, bury whatever *sūkaramaddava* is left over in a pit. Cunda, I do not see anyone in this world with its devas, Māras, and Brahmās, in this generation with its ascetics and Brahmins, its devas and humans, who could properly digest this when eaten, other than the Tathāgata (*tathāgato*)."

"Yes, Bhante," Cunda the smith replied to the Blessed One. Having buried the remaining *sūkaramaddava* in a pit, he went to the Blessed One; having approached, he paid respects to the Blessed One and sat down to one side. As Cunda the smith sat there, the Blessed One instructed, encouraged, inspired, and gladdened him with a talk on the Dhamma, and then rose from his seat and departed.

Atha kho bhagavato cundassa kammāraputtassa bhattam bhuttāvissa kharo ābādho uppajji. Lohitapakkhandikā pabālha vedanā vattanti māraṇantikā. Tatra suda bhagavā sato sampajāno adhivāsesi avihaññamāno.

After the Blessed One had eaten Cunda the smith's meal, a severe illness arose. A discharge of blood occurred, with sharp, deadly sensations (*vedanās*). The Blessed One, aware, with constant thorough understanding (*sato sampajāno*), endured it undisturbed.

Atha kho bhagavā āyasmantaṃ ānandaṃ āmantesi: “āyāmānanda, yena kusinārā tenupasaṅkamissāmā”ti. “Evaṃ, bhante”ti kho āyasmā ānando bhagavato paccassosi.

Then the Blessed One addressed Venerable Ānanda: "Come, Ānanda, let us go to Kusinārā." "Yes, Bhante," Venerable Ānanda replied to the Blessed One.

Cundassa bhattaṃ bhuñjitvā, kammārassāti me sutaṃ; Ābādhaṃ samphusī dhīro, pabāḷhaṃ māraṇantikaṃ.

Bhuttassa ca sūkaramaddavena, Byādhippabāḷho udapādi satthuno; Viriccamāno bhagavā avoca, “Gacchāmaḥ kusināraṃ nagaraṃ”ti.

Having eaten the meal from Cunda the smith— so have I heard— the Wise One experienced a sharp illness, severe and bordering on death.

After eating the *sūkaramaddava*, a severe sickness arose in the Teacher. Purging, the Blessed One said: "I am going to the city of Kusinārā."

Atha kho bhagavā maggā okkamma yena aññātaraṃ rukkhamūlaṃ tenupasaṅkami; upasaṅkamitvā āyasmantaṃ ānandaṃ āmantesi: “iñgha me tvaṃ, ānanda, catugguṇaṃ saṅghāṭiṃ paññāpehi; kilantosmi, ānanda, nisīdissāmi”ti. “Evaṃ, bhante”ti kho āyasmā ānando bhagavato paṭissutvā catugguṇaṃ saṅghāṭiṃ paññāpesi. Nisīdi bhagavā pañatte āsane. Nisajja kho bhagavā āyasmantaṃ ānandaṃ āmantesi: “iñgha me tvaṃ, ānanda, pānīyaṃ āhara; pipāsitosmi, ānanda, pivissāmi”ti.

Then the Blessed One, stepping off the path, went to the foot of a certain tree. Having approached, he addressed Venerable Ānanda: "Please, Ānanda, fold my outer robe in four and spread it out. I am tired, Ānanda, I want to sit down." "Yes, Bhante," Venerable Ānanda replied, and folded the outer robe in four and spread it out. The Blessed One sat down on the prepared seat. Having sat down, the Blessed One addressed Venerable Ānanda: "Please, Ānanda, bring me some water. I am thirsty, Ānanda, I want to drink."

Evaṃ vutte, āyasmā ānando bhagavantaṃ etadavoca: “idāni, bhante, pañcamattāni sakaṭasatāni atikkantāni. Taṃ cakkacchinnaṃ udakaṃ parittaṃ luḷitaṃ āvilaṃ sandati. Ayaṃ, bhante, kukudhā nadī avidūre acchodakā sātodakā sītodakā setodakā supatitthā ramaṇīyā. Ettha bhagavā pānīyaṃ pivissati gattāni ca sītīkarissatī”ti.

When this was said, Venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One: "Bhante, five hundred carts have just crossed over. That water, cut up by the wheels, flows shallow, stirred up, and turbid. Bhante, the Kakutthā River is nearby, with clear, sweet, cool, and clean water, with beautiful landing places, and is delightful. There the Blessed One can drink the water and cool his limbs."

Dutiyampi kho ...pe... tatiyampi kho bhagavā āyasmantaṃ ānandaṃ āmantesi: "iṅgha me tvaṃ, ānanda, pāṇīyaṃ āhara; pipāsitosmi, ānanda, pivissāmi"ti. "Evaṃ, bhante"ti kho āyasmā ānando bhagavato paṭissutvā pattaṃ gahetvā yena sā nadī tenupasaṅkami. Atha kho sā nadī cakkacchinnā parittā luḷitā āvilā sandamānā āyasmante ānande upasaṅkamante acchā vipprasannā anāvilā sandati.

A second time... And a third time the Blessed One addressed Venerable Ānanda: "Please, Ānanda, bring me some water. I am thirsty, Ānanda, I want to drink." "Yes, Bhante," Venerable Ānanda replied to the Blessed One. Taking the bowl, he went to that stream. Then, that stream, though cut up by the wheels, shallow, stirred up, and turbid, flowed clear, pure, and clean as Venerable Ānanda approached.

Atha kho āyasmato ānandassa etadahosi: "acchariyaṃ vata bho, abbhutaṃ vata bho, tathāgatassa mahiddhikatā mahānubhāvatā. Ayañhi sā nadī cakkacchinnā parittā luḷitā āvilā sandamānā mayi upasaṅkamante acchā vipprasannā anāvilā sandati"ti. Pattaṃ pāṇīyaṃ ādāya yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami; upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantaṃ etadavoca: "acchariyaṃ, bhante, abbhutaṃ, bhante, tathāgatassa mahiddhikatā mahānubhāvatā. Ayañhi sā, bhante, nadī cakkacchinnā parittā luḷitā āvilā sandamānā mayi upasaṅkamante acchā vipprasannā anāvilā sandati. Pivatu bhagavā pāṇīyaṃ, pivatu sugato pāṇīyaṃ"ti.

Then it occurred to Venerable Ānanda: "How wonderful, how marvelous is the great power and majesty of the Tathāgata! For this stream, though cut up by the wheels, shallow, stirred up, and turbid, flowed clear, pure, and clean as I approached." Taking the water in the bowl, he went to the Blessed One. Having approached, he said to the Blessed One: "How wonderful, Bhante, how marvelous, Bhante, is the great power and majesty of the Tathāgata! For this stream, though cut up by the wheels, shallow, stirred up, and turbid, flowed clear, pure, and clean as I approached. Let the Blessed One drink the water; let the Sugata (*Sugata*) drink the water."

Atha kho bhagavā pāṇīyaṃ apāyi. Atha kho bhagavā mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ yena kukudhā nadī tenupasaṅkami; upasaṅkamitvā kukudhaṃ nadiṃ ajjhogāhetvā nhatvā ca pivitvā ca paccuttaritvā yena ambavanaṃ tenupasaṅkami. Upasaṅkamitvā āyasmantaṃ cundakaṃ āmantesi: "iṅgha me tvaṃ, cundaka, catugguṇaṃ saṅghāṭiṃ paññāpehi; kilantosmi, cundaka, nipajjissāmi"ti.

Then the Blessed One drank the water. Then, the Blessed One went with the large community of monks to the Kakutthā River. Having arrived, he entered the Kakutthā River, bathed, drank,

and crossed back over, and then went to the mango grove. Having arrived, he addressed Venerable Cundaka: "Please, Cundaka, fold my outer robe in four and spread it out. I am tired, Cundaka, I want to lie down."

“Evaṃ, bhante”ti kho āyasmā cundako bhagavato paṭissutvā catugguṇaṃ saṅghāṭiṃ paññāpesi. Atha kho bhagavā dakkhiṇena passena sīhaseyyaṃ kappesi pāde pādaṃ accādhāya sato sampajāno uṭṭhānasaññaṃ manasi karitvā. Āyasmā pana cundako tattheva bhagavato purato nisīdi.

"Yes, Bhante," Venerable Cundaka replied, and folded the outer robe in four and spread it out. Then the Blessed One lay down on his right side in the lion's posture, placing one foot on top of the other, aware, with constant thorough understanding, keeping in mind the time to arise. Meanwhile, Venerable Cundaka sat there right before the Blessed One.

Gantvāna buddho nadikaṃ kukudhaṃ, Acchodakaṃ sātudakaṃ vippasannaṃ;
Ogāhi satthā sukilantarūpo, Tathāgato appaṭimodha loke.

Nhatvā ca pivitvā cudatāri satthā, Purakkhato bhikkhugaṇassa majjhe; Satthā pavattā bhagavā idha dhamme, Upāgami ambavanaṃ mahesi; Āmantayi cundakaṃ nāma bhikkhuṃ, “Catugguṇaṃ santhara me nipajjaṃ”.

So codito bhāvitattena cundo, Catugguṇaṃ santhari khippameva; Nipajji satthā sukilantarūpo, Cundopi tattha pamukhe nisīdīti.

The Buddha went to the Kakutthā River, with its clear, sweet, and pure water. The Teacher, though deeply exhausted, plunged in— the Tathāgata, peerless in the world.

Having bathed and drunk, the Teacher crossed over, surrounded by the community of monks in their midst. The Teacher, the Blessed One, who here proclaimed the Dhamma, the Great Seer, arrived at the mango grove. He addressed the monk named Cundaka: "Spread out my robe folded in four, so I may lie down."

Urged by the one of cultivated mind, Cundaka quickly spread it out folded in four. The Teacher lay down, deeply exhausted, while Cundaka sat there right before him.

Atha kho bhagavā āyasmantaṃ ānandaṃ āmantesi: “siyā kho panānanda, cundassa kammāraputtassa koci vippaṭisāraṃ upadaheyya: ‘tassa te, āvuso cunda, alābhā, tassa te dulladdhaṃ yassa te tathāgato pacchimaṃ piṇḍapātaṃ bhuñjitvā parinibbuto’ti. Cundassānanda, kammāraputtassa evaṃ vippaṭisāro paṭivinodetabbo—

Tassa te, āvuso cunda, lābhā, tassa te suladdhaṃ yassa te tathāgato pacchimaṃ piṇḍapātaṃ paribhuñjitvā parinibbuto. Sammukhā metaṃ, āvuso cunda, bhagavato

sutaṃ, sammukhā paṭiggahitaṃ— dveme piṇḍapātā samasamaphalā samasamavipākā ativiya aññehi piṇḍapātehi mahapphalatarā ca mahānisaṃsatarā ca. Katame dve? Yañca piṇḍapātāṃ paribhuñjitvā tathāgato anuttaraṃ sammāsambodhiṃ abhisambujjhati, yañca piṇḍapātāṃ paribhuñjitvā anupādisesāya nibbānadhātuyā parinibbāyati. Ime dve piṇḍapātā samasamaphalā samasamavipākā ativiya aññehi piṇḍapātehi mahapphalatarā ca mahānisaṃsatarā ca.

‘Āyusaṃvattanikaṃ āyasmatā cundena kammāraputtena kammaṃ upacitaṃ, vaṇṇasaṃvattanikaṃ āyasmatā cundena kammāraputtena kammaṃ upacitaṃ, sukhasaṃvattanikaṃ āyasmatā cundena kammāraputtena kammaṃ upacitaṃ, saggasaṃvattanikaṃ āyasmatā cundena kammāraputtena kammaṃ upacitaṃ, yasasaṃvattanikaṃ āyasmatā cundena kammāraputtena kammaṃ upacitaṃ, ādhipateyyasaṃvattanikaṃ āyasmatā cundena kammāraputtena kammaṃ upacitaṃ’ti. Cundassānanda, kammāraputtassa eva vipphaṇṇasāro paṭivinodetabbo”ti.

Then the Blessed One addressed Venerable Ānanda: "It may happen, Ānanda, that someone might cause Cunda the smith to feel remorse, saying: 'Friend Cunda, it is a loss for you, it is poorly gained by you, that the Tathāgata attained final liberation (*parinibbāna*) after eating his last meal from you.' Any remorse in Cunda the smith, Ānanda, should be dispelled in this way:

'Friend Cunda, it is a gain for you, it is well gained by you, that the Tathāgata attained final liberation after eating his last meal from you. I have heard this directly from the Blessed One's mouth, and received it directly from him: These two meals are of equal fruit, of equal result, far more fruitful and beneficial than any other meals. Which two? The meal after eating which the Tathāgata attains supreme full enlightenment (*sammāsambodhi*), and the meal after eating which the Tathāgata passes away into the element of final liberation (*nibbāna*) without any substrate remaining. These two meals are of equal fruit, of equal result, far more fruitful and beneficial than any other meals.

Cunda the smith has accumulated kamma (*kamma*) that leads to long life, that leads to beauty, that leads to happiness, that leads to heaven, that leads to fame, and that leads to sovereignty.' Any remorse in Cunda the smith, Ānanda, should be dispelled in this way."

Atha kho bhagavā etamatthaṃ veditvā tāyaṃ velāyaṃ imaṃ udānaṃ udānesi:

“Dadato puññaṃ pavaḍḍhati, Saṃyamato veraṃ na cīyati; Kusalo ca jahāti pāpakaṃ, Rāgadosamohakkhayā sanibbuto”ti.

Pañcamaṃ.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the significance of this, uttered this inspired utterance at that time: "Giving, one's merit increases; self-controlled, no enmity accumulates. The wise one

discards what is unwholesome, and with the destruction of craving, aversion, and ignorance, one is fully at peace." (Fifth)